

IND-PV-SOP-002 — COVID Impact Baseline & Recovery Playbook

Document ID: IND-PV-SOP-002 **Version:** 1.4 **Effective date:** 01-Mar-2021 **Last review:** 10-May-2026 **Owner:** Commercial Excellence / India PV Strategy **Audience:** CXO, Sales Heads, FP&A, Regional Controllers **Related data:** India PV retail fact table 2019–2026 (sales_date, order_qty, total_sales)

1. Purpose

Provide a **standard interpretation framework** for COVID-era volume shocks and post-COVID recovery so analysts and AI narratives do not mis-label 2020 weakness as “brand failure” or treat 2020 as a normal base year.

2. Market context (India PV)

Period — Expected pattern in this dataset — Narrative stance

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2019 — Pre-COVID baseline demand — Normal reference year

2020 (esp. Apr–Jun) — Sharp lockdown-driven collapse — **Depressed baseline** — cite COVID

2021 — Partial recovery / chip & supply constraints — Transition year

2022–2023 — Strong rebound + SUV mix shift — Recovery confirmation

2024–2025 — Near-peak retail momentum — Expansion / competitive intensity

2026 H1 — Partial year — do not annualise blindly — Flag incomplete year

Observed shape in the reference extract (~55k orders): 2019 ~6.2k orders → 2020 ~2.5k → 2021 ~5.1k → rising through 2025. Narratives that ignore this arc are **non-compliant**.

3. Mandatory analysis rules

3.1 Never use 2020 as a “healthy” YoY base without disclaimer

When computing YoY growth vs 2020:

- Always add context: “vs COVID-depressed 2020 base”.
- Prefer dual comparison: vs 2019 **and** vs prior year.
- If only one YoY is shown and base is 2020, mark trust commentary as “context-sensitive”.

3.2 Lockdown months

April–June 2020 are **structural outliers**, not forecasting training months for “normal seasonality”.

Allowed language:

- “Lockdown-driven trough”
- “Demand freeze / dealership closure effect”

Disallowed language without evidence:

- “Maruti lost competitiveness in Q2-2020”
- “Brand collapse” when the dip is industry-wide

3.3 Recovery confirmation checklist

A region or OEM is considered **recovered** when:

- Units in the latest full year ≥ 90% of 2019 units for that slice, **or**

- Two consecutive full years of YoY unit growth post-2021, **and**
- No reliance on a single festive month spike alone.

4. How to answer executive questions

Executive question — Required analytical approach

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“Why were 2020 sales down?” — Show units by month/quarter 2019–2021; attribute Apr–Jun trough to lockdown; avoid OEM blame unless share shifted vs peers

“Have we recovered?” — Compare latest full year units & revenue vs 2019; show EV share separately (see SOP-003)

“Is 2025 growth sustainable?” — Separate festive Q4 uplift from underlying H1 run-rate; check OEM concentration (Maruti/Tata/Mahindra)

“Where should we invest next?” — Regions still below 2019 units; EV white-space cities; under-indexed makes

5. Narrative templates (approved)

Template A — COVID trough

> “Units fell sharply in 2020 versus 2019, with the deepest trough in Apr–Jun during national lockdowns. This should be read as an industry demand shock, not an isolated brand failure, unless share vs peers also deteriorated.”

Template B — Recovery

> “From 2021 onward, order volumes rebuilt and surpassed pre-COVID levels by 2023–2024. Leadership should treat 2019 as the strategic baseline and 2020 as a one-time discontinuity.”

Template C — Incomplete year

> “2026 figures cover only H1 in the current extract. Do not annualise H1 × 2 without adjusting for festive-weighted H2.”

6. KPI overlays during recovery reviews

Always present **Units** and **Revenue** together:

- Volume recovery can precede ASP recovery (discounting).
- Revenue recovery without units may indicate mix shift to higher ASP SUVs / EVs.

7. Governance

Any board pack that shows a 2020 YoY chart **must** include the COVID disclaimer footnote. All narratives must inject the same disclaimer when the result set is dominated by 2020 comparisons.